

Reported Questions

CEFR B1

Lesson Pack · summary, worksheet & answer key

Quick answer

Reported questions look like statements, not questions. The key changes are:

- 1 Statement word order — 'Where do you live?' → She asked where I lived (not 'where did I live').
- 2 Yes/no questions take 'if' or 'whether' — 'Are you ok?' → He asked if I was ok.
- 3 No 'do/does/did' and no question mark.

The tense backshifts like reported statements. Use 'asked' (or 'wanted to know'), and keep the wh-word for wh-questions.

At a glance

Direct question	Reported question
"Where do you live? "	She asked where I lived.
"What is your name?"	He asked what my name was.
" Are you ready?"	She asked if I was ready.
" Do you like it?"	He asked whether I liked it.
"Why did she leave?"	They asked why she had left.

Learning objectives

- Can report wh- and yes/no questions with statement word order (CEFR B1).
- Can use 'if' or 'whether' for yes/no questions and drop the auxiliary 'do'.
- Can backshift tenses and remove the question mark.



Practice worksheet

Circle the correct option. Reported Questions · CEFR B1

Name: _____

Date: _____

1. "Where do you live?" → She asked where ____.

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|---------------|------------|
| A. do I live | B. I lived |
| C. did I live | D. I live |

2. "Are you ready?" → He asked ____ ready.

- | | |
|-------------|----------|
| A. if I was | B. was I |
| C. if was I | D. am I |

3. "What is your name?" → She asked what ____.

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|----------------|----------------|
| A. is my name | B. my name was |
| C. was my name | D. did my name |

4. "Do you like coffee?" → He asked ____ coffee.

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|---------------|------------------|
| A. if I liked | B. do I like |
| C. did I like | D. if did I like |

5. "Why did she leave?" → They asked why ____.

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|------------------|-----------------|
| A. did she leave | B. she had left |
| C. she left? | D. she leaves |

6. "Can you swim?" → She asked ____ swim.

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|---------------|------------|
| A. if I could | B. can I |
| C. if can I | D. could I |

7. "What are you doing?" → He asked what ____.

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|------------------|----------------|
| A. are you doing | B. I was doing |
| C. was I doing | D. am I doing |

8. Correct this: 'She asked me where did I work.'

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|-----------------------------------|-----------------------------------|
| A. She asked me where I worked. | B. She asked me where did I work. |
| C. She asked me where I did work. | D. She asked me where do I work. |

9. "Have you seen my keys?" → He asked ____ his keys.

- | | |
|------------------|-------------------|
| A. if I had seen | B. have I seen |
| C. did I see | D. if have I seen |

10. Which reported question is correct?

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|-------------------------------------|--|
| A. She asked when the film started. | B. She asked when did the film start. |
| C. She asked when the film started? | D. She asked when does the film start. |

Answer key

Correct answers with explanations · for the teacher

1. **B. I lived** — Statement order + backshift: 'She asked where I lived'.
2. **A. if I was** — Yes/no questions take 'if' + statement order: 'He asked if I was ready'.
3. **B. my name was** — Statement order + backshift: 'She asked what my name was'.
4. **A. if I liked** — Yes/no questions take 'if' + backshift: 'He asked if I liked coffee'.
5. **B. she had left** — Statement order + backshift: 'They asked why she had left'.
6. **A. if I could** — Yes/no + backshift: 'She asked if I could swim'.
7. **B. I was doing** — Statement order + backshift: 'He asked what I was doing'.
8. **A. She asked me where I worked.** — Drop 'did', use statement order + backshift: 'where I worked'.
9. **A. if I had seen** — Yes/no + backshift: 'He asked if I had seen his keys'.
10. **A. She asked when the film started.** — Statement order, backshift, no question mark: 'She asked when the film started'.